

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dada DiCapo

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

- Went to art school with **Vincent Van Faux**. They still remember each other's worst work.
- **Elle Loominate** has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.
- Has made commissioned work for **Tess Tament**. **Tess** still asks whether one piece is meant to make that noise.
- Performed inside a sculpture by **Al Baster**. Dada assumed the invitation to the opening covered that.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling. Art is money. Art is life.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Dada DiCapo

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Your other secret

You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Conversations to start

- Enjoy watching people overreact to your warning note without admitting you wrote it.
- Find out whether Minnie Malist changed the lighting cue you designed.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*
- 2 *A secret waits behind drapes the colour of spilled wine.*
- 3 *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Any Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I wrote the warning. Grant stole my closing performance and put his foundation's name under it. 'Return what was taken' was an instruction, not an obituary. I wanted him to recognize his own theft in front of an audience. He offered to credit me as a consultant. I am still deciding which insult deserved the louder response.

IF MURDERER

The warning was mine. Grant stole the performance, and I wanted his guests to know whose idea they were enjoying. He suggested I could bow beside him as a consultant. I had already planted the note. He was beginning to understand that commissioning an artist and owning an artist are different arrangements.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Before the toast I was on the rehearsal platform making a shadow figure misbehave. Grant wanted it to bow. I wanted it to take his hat. I stayed through the rehearsal, then went looking for the programme with the stolen credit. A small mechanical hand can express a considerable amount of contempt.

IF MURDERER

I rehearsed the shadow figure, then let its automatic sequence run while I went through the gallery. Around 6:42 I checked whether my warning had reached Grant's papers. I returned to the platform for the closing bow. He had ordered a spectacle, and I intended him to feel included in it.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Those red shoes under the platform are mine. The rehearsal camera shows me wearing them for the whole 6:39–6:45 take; my shadow figure has neither feet nor opinions. I used museum linen for its costume and the preparation key for a prop cupboard. I also forged the foundation's signature on its ridiculous little hat.

IF MURDERER

The figure wore museum linen and a little foundation hat I had lettered myself. I used the preparation key to collect its props. My red shoes were beside the platform while the automatic sequence ran. Grant believed the bow was a tribute. I have occasionally allowed a patron to misunderstand his commission.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Dada DiCapo

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Dada DiCapo

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I planted the warning and forged a signature on a puppet's hat. I was also visibly on the platform for the entire contamination interval. The shadow recording is uncut. Grant stole my work; I meant to make him watch it misbehave. You may charge me with artistic malice. The poison belongs to somebody else.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The automatic sequence bowed while I worked in the salon. I took the toxin through the prop cupboard access, soaked museum linen and wiped Grant's coupe. The warning supplied an audience for his discomfort; the glass supplied an ending. The red shoes on the floor were a costume change, not a person remaining onstage.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
